

PAVAN KUMAR

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SUMMARY

Technical Product Manager with 7+ years building loyalty, engagement, and commerce platforms at scale. Led 40M+ member rewards programs, shipped data-driven personalization, and partnered across engineering, data science, design, and marketing to drive measurable outcomes. Increasingly focused on integrating AI/ML capabilities into consumer products — from LLM-powered personalization to behavioral prediction models. Proven track record influencing cross-functional teams and translating data into product decisions.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Product: Roadmapping, A/B testing, loyalty & engagement systems, personalization, behavioral analytics, API product design

Technical: SQL, Python, REST APIs, Looker, Amplitude, LaunchDarkly, Jira, Figma, Backstage, OpenTelemetry

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Manager, Loyalty & Commerce – JCPenney

Apr 2024 – Feb 2026

- Owned end-to-end roadmap for JCPenney Rewards (10M+ members); drove personalization and retention initiatives increasing repeat purchase rate by 18%.
- Led tiered loyalty redesign aligning points, perks, and offer mechanics with LTV signals — resulting in a 22% lift in engaged member spend.
- Partnered with data science to build propensity-based offer targeting, reducing promotional cost per conversion by 15% while improving redemption rates.
- Drove post-launch optimizations via A/B testing and cohort analysis; improved new member 30-day activation by 24%.

Technical Product Manager, Platform – The New York Times

Sept 2022 – Mar 2024

- Built NYT Backstage developer portal adopted by 200+ engineers, standardizing observability and service ownership across 80+ microservices.
- Integrated OpenTelemetry-based tracing reducing MTTR by 35% YoY; launched FinOps dashboards identifying \$2M+ in cloud inefficiencies and driving 26% cost reduction.
- Aligned roadmap across 4 engineering teams and editorial/infrastructure leadership on quarterly planning; ran transparent stakeholder reviews with clear metric accountability.
- Championed tooling adoption through documentation and onboarding programs, increasing developer portal usage 60% in two quarters without formal authority.

Technical Product Manager, Rewards – Starbucks

June 2018 – Aug 2022

- Core PM for Starbucks Rewards (#1 U.S. loyalty program, 40M+ active members); owned feature roadmap spanning points, tiers, personalized offers, and gamified challenges.
- Shipped Stars for Everyone — earn mechanic for non-app purchases — growing enrolled member base 14% in first quarter post-launch.
- Built personalized push notification and offer targeting system with data science; increased offer redemption rates 31% through behavioral segmentation.
- Defined and tracked engagement KPIs (DAU, offer CTR, tier upgrade rate, churn); translated behavioral insights into iterative iOS/Android improvements.
- Localized loyalty mechanics for 4 international markets, adapting earn/redeem rules to regional regulatory requirements in partnership with legal and marketing.

PROJECTS

- Building an app every day — shipping a new product daily to sharpen full-stack and AI prototyping skills. github.com/kumarpav

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Informatics – University of Washington

Sep 2015 – Jun 2019